Chapter 3

The basic linguistic features of the Teop language

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1 Introduction

Teop is a configurational language. The building blocks of clauses are eight types of phrases which are formed by content words and specific functional words in a strict word order[1], see (1).

(1) *A ba suburaara na kuukuhi overe ni roho bona kehaa.*
a ba subu-raara na kuu~kuhi
[ART2.SG KIN.PL grandparent-1PL.IN.POSS.PRON]$_{NP}$ [TM2 RED~grate
overe ni roho bona kehaa
coconut APPL before]$_{VC}$ [OBJ.ART2.SG shell]$_{NP}$
'Our grandparents grated coconuts with a shell.' (5:75)

The eight types of phrases are distinguished in the following way:

1. Noun Phrase (NP): The NP is introduced by an obligatory Article signifying the lexical class of the NP head, which is distinct from its word class, and the specificity of its reference, its grammatical number, and its syntactic function. The head of the NP may be a Noun (N), a Verb (V), or an Adjective (Adj).

[1]The terms of Teop formal categories of words, phrases and clauses are distinguished from terms for typological comparative concepts by capital letters, see Haspelmath (2016), e.g. topical subject Noun Phrase.

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2. Locative Phrase (LocP): The LocP has the same structure as the NP, but lacks an Article. It is headed by a Noun that refers to a specific place.

3. Verb Complex (VC): The first position of the VC is optionally held by one of the eight particles that signify temporal relations and modality (Gloss: TM1–TM8) and its last position by the Imperfective or the Perfective Aspect Marker (Gloss: IPFV, PFV). Affirmative VCs are headed by a Verb (V), a Noun (N), an Adjective (Adj), or a Cardinal Numeral (Num). In addition, the core of a VC that is negated by the Double Negator may consist of a Noun Phrase (NP), a Prepositional Phrase (PrepP) or a Linker Phrase (LnkP), See Section 4.2 and Section 7.1.

4. Adjectival Phrase (AdjP): The AdjP is marked by an Article that formally agrees with the Article of the NP it relates to as a predicate or an attribute. It is headed by an Adjective (Adj) or a Verb (V).

5. Numeral Phrase (NumP): The NumP is headed by a Cardinal Numeral and marked by an Article that formally agrees with the Article of the NP it relates to in the function of an attribute or anaphoric argument.

6. Substitute Phrase (SubstP): The SubstP is marked by an Article and headed by *vuaba* 'one' or *meha*/*meho* 'other' and functions as an anaphoric substitute for a NP. The selection of the Article and the form *meha* or *meho* is determined by its antecedent.

7. Prepositional Phrase (PrepP): The PrepPs are introduced by a preposition which is followed by a Pronoun or NP. The most frequent preposition is the Multi-Purpose Preposition *te* 'PREP'.

8. Linker Phrase (LnkP): The LnkP is introduced by the Linker *vaa* 'LNK' which is followed by an Adverb (Adv), a LocP, a PrepP introduced by *te* 'PREP', or a complement clause introduced by *tea* 'COMPL1'.

The following grammatical description of Teop starts with syntactically simple Non-Verbal Clauses (Section 2) and Verbal Clauses (Section 3), which is followed by an overview of the syntactic functions of phrases in Section 4, Then the classification of the content words and Numerals is presented in Section 5 on the basis of their distribution within the phrases. The morphology of content words is described in Section 6. The following sections deal with the complex structures of VCs (Section 7) and NPs (Section 8). The forms and syntactic functions of Pronouns are listed in tables and explained in Section 9. The final two sections are

about the Alienable and Inalienable Possessive Constructions (Section 10) and dependent clauses (Section 11).

The Teop phonology and orthography have been described by Radtke (2005).

Information on inflectional and derivational morphemes, grammatical particles and constructions on phrase level is also given in the Multifunctional Teop-English Dictionary (MTED), Mosel (2019), which facilitates filtered searches for lexemes, parts of speech, meaning descriptions, bound morphemes, glosses, multi-word constructions, and semantic domains. An introduction to complex filtered search strategies is given in Section 12.

2 Non-Verbal Clauses

There are four types of Non-Verbal Clauses:

1. Existential clauses consist of a single NP and state the existence of the NP referent (2a).

2. In topic-comment clauses, a topical subject NP (3), Pronoun, anaphoric NumP or SubstP (2b, 6) is followed by a predicative NP (3), AdjP (4), LocP (2b) or PrepP (6).

3. In thetic[2] non-verbal clauses the non-topical subject form follows the predicate form (5).

4. The negative existential clause is formed by the Negator *ahiki* 'not exist' and a non-specific NP (7).

The text excerpt below starts with a PrepP referring to the topic which is followed by an existential clause and two topic-comment clauses with predicative LocPs, see (2).

(2) a. *Teo potee, o buaku koa o vanai,*

te=o potee o buaku koa o
[PREP=ART3.SG potee]$_{PrepP}$ [[ART3.SG two only]$_{NumP}$ ART3.SG
vanai
outrigger.boom]$_{NP}$

'As for the *potee* canoe, there are only two outrigger booms,'[3]

[2] Lambrecht (1994: 137–146), Sasse (1987).

[3] NPs with an attributive NumP are always singular.

b. *o peho matana, o meho he itao.*
o peho mata-na o meho
[ART3.SG one3.SG]$_{NumP}$ [front-DEREL]$_{LocP}$ [ART3.SG other3.SG]$_{SubstP}$
he itao
ADVERS [stern]$_{LocP}$
'one near the bow, and the other near the stern.' (24:44)

In (3) a NP functions as the subject and a second NP as the predicate. The latter is modified by an attributive AdjP, see (3).

(3) *A goroto a iana a beera sana.*
a goroto a iana a beera sana
ART2.SG turtle ART2.SG swimming.animal ART2.SG big very
'The turtle is a very big swimming animal.' (26:2)

AdjPs may also function as a predicate, see (4).

(4) *O atovo o mataa,*
o atovo o mataa
ART3.SG sago.palm ART3.SG good
'The sago palm is good,' (6:54)

The ambiguity of NP-AdjP constructions is resolved by the context or by *vai* 'DEM6' which links the attributive AdjP to the NP, see (26) in Section 4.2.

In thetic clauses, which focus on the whole situation and lack a topical NP, the predicative AdjP precedes the non-topical subject NP, see (5).

(5) *A pereperee ge kasikasiree a kapa nae.*
a pereperee ge kasikasiree a kapa nae
ART2.SG green or yellow ART2.SG cover 3SG.POSS.PRON
'(When it grows bigger, they call it *magura* 'ripening coconut.') Its cover is green or yellow.' (5:38)

A predicative PrepP is found in the description of making a net for catching turtles,[4] see (6).

(6) a. *O peho teo meho punete,*
o peho te=o meho punete
[ART3.SG one3.SG]$_{NumP}$ [PREP=ART3.SG other3.SG edge]$_{PrepP}$
'(When this work is finished, we get two helmet shells for the bottom of the net.) One (is) for one edge,'

[4] A predicative PrepP introduced by *mene* occurs in (16:37).

b. *o meho he teo meho punete.*
o meho he te=o meho
[ART3.SG other3.SG]$_{SubstP}$ ADVERS [PREP=ART3.SG other3.SG
punete
edge]$_{PrepP}$
'the other (is) one for the other edge.' (27:28)

Negative existential clauses are formed by the Negator *ahiki* 'not exist'[5] and a NP marked by a Non-Specific Article (see Section 8.2). The example below comes from a text about a pandanus species, see (7).

(7) *Ahiki to toutou teve.*
ahiki to toutou teve
not.exist [NSPEC3.SG thorns PREP.3.SG.PRON]$_{NP}$
'It does not have any thorns.' (lit. 'There aren't any thorns of it.') (13:18)

Predicative NPs and PrepPs are negated by the verbal Double Negator Construction, see Section 4.2. Predicative AdjPs are negated by a VC which is marked by the Double Negator and headed by the AdjP, compare (4) with (20:10).

3 Verbal Clauses

In topic-comment Verbal Clauses, the VC follows a clause initial topical NP, Pronoun, or anaphoric phrase which in transitive clauses may function as the subject or the object. Topical NPs and non-topical subject NPs are marked by a Basic Article. But non-topical object NPs are only marked by the Basic Article (See Section 8.2), if the topical subject is formed by a 1st or 2nd person Pronoun, see (8).

(8) *Eara repaa karem vakakaniva a peha papana.*
e-ara re= paa karem va-kakaniva a peha
H-1PL.IN.PRON CONSEC= [TM3 scrape CAUS-sharp]$_{VC}$ ART2.SG one2.SG
papana
end
'Then we sharpen one end.' (5:55)

But if an NP or a 3rd person Pronoun functions as the topical subject, the object NP is marked by the Object Article, see (9).

[5]The Negator *ahiki* 'not being there' can be analyzed as a NP formed by the Article *a* 'ART2.SG' and the Verb *hiki* 'not exist, not have', https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-hiki_1, but it is never written as two words.

(9) *A abana na mosi maari bono kopihoo ...*
a abana na mosi maa=ri bono kopihoo
ART2.SG men [TM2 cut hither=3PL.IPFV]$_{VC}$ OBJ.ART3.SG kopihoo
'The men cut a *kopihoo* tree ...' (23:3)

When the topical NP functions as the object, the subject NP or Pronoun follows the VC, see (10).

(10) *O kaku vagana bona na pakupaku raara teo gohoho ge teo tarahi,*
o kaku vagana bona na paku~paku ra=
[ART3.SG kind fish ANA.SG]$_{NP}$ [TM2 RED~do 1PL.IN.IPFV=]$_{VC}$
ara te=o gohoho ge te=o tarahi
1PL.IN.PRON PREP=ART3.SG incoming.tide or PREP=ART3.SG ebbing.tide
'This kind of fishing we do during the incoming tide or during the ebbing tide,' (30:3)

Ditransitive clauses are frequent in this text collection, because in Teop the primary and secondary object NPs do not only refer to the recipient and the theme of a transfer,[6] but also to the patient and the instrument of an action or the product of an action and the material it is made of. The structure of ditransitive clauses is summarized in Table 1.

Table 1: Ditransitive clauses with a topic-comment structure.

TOPIC	VC	NON-TOPICAL ARGUMENTS		REF
subj: H-1PL.IN.PRON	VC_{DTR}	1st obj: ART N	2nd obj: OBJ.ART N	(11)
subj: H-3PL.PRON	VC_{DTR}	1st obj: OBJ.ART N	2nd obj: OBJ.ART N	(12)
1st obj: ART N	VC_{DTR}	subj: 1PL.IN.PRON	2nd obj: OBJ.ART N	(13)
2nd obj: ART N	VC_{DTR}	subj: 3PL.PRON	1st obj: NP	(14)

The primary object NPs are treated like the object NP of transitive clauses. It is marked by the Basic Article, if the topical subject is formed by a 1st or 2nd Person Pronoun, see (11).

(11) *..., eara na tasu rara a koopu bona toraara.*
e-ara na tasu rara a koopu bona toraara
H-1PL.IN.PRON TM2 beat 1PL.IN.IPFV ART3.PL bamboo OBJ.ART2.SG axe
'..., we beat the *koopu* bamboos with an axe.' (19:21)

[6] Cf. Malchukov et al. (2010: 1–2). For examples of *hee* 'give' see Mosel (2010: 487–500) and https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-hee.

But if the topical subject is formed by a 3rd Person Pronoun or a NP, the primary object NP is marked by the Object Article, see (12).

(12) *eori repaa kahu mana bono kara baneo bona kehaa*
e-ori re= paa kahu mana bono kara
H-3PL.PRON CONSEC= [TM3 scrape eventually]$_{VC}$ OBJ.ART3.SG fibre
baneo bona kehaa
breadfruit_tree OBJ.ART3.SG shell
'they eventually scrape the breadfruit tree fibres with a shell (that they call *sui*).' (8:20)

The Basic Article only marks non-topical secondary object NPs, if both the subject and the primary object are formed by a 1st or 2nd Person Pronoun.[7]

When the primary object functions as the topic, the subject is formed by a Pronoun that directly follows the VC and the secondary object NP is marked by the Object Article irrespective of the person of the subject Pronoun, see (13).

(13) *O pusu hiovu na paku raara bene ta boon.*
o pusu_hiovu na paku ra= ara bene
ART3.SG husker [TM2 make 1PL.IN.IPFV=]$_{VC}$ 1PL.IN.PRON OBJ.ART1.SG
ta boon
piece mangrove
'We make the husker from a piece of mangrove wood.' (lit. 'The husker make we') (5:52)

The same clause structure is found with secondary object NPs functioning as the topic, see (14):

(14) *O pihae vai o pereperee na paku riori bona bero a taba.*
o pihae vai o pereperee na paku
ART3.SG coconut.frond DEM6 ART3.SG green TM2 make
ri=ori bona bero[8] a taba
3PL.IPFV=3PL.PRON OBJ.ART2.SG many ART2.SG thing
'The green coconut frond is used for many things.' (lit. '... make they many things.') (5:100)

[7]There is no example in this text collection where both the subject and the primary object are formed by a 1st or 2nd person Pronoun, but see *Ean toro hee anaa a moon.* 'You must give me the girl.' in Mosel (2010: 490).

[8]The word *bero* 'many' heads a NumPs in (14), but it also functions as the head of a VC, see (13:8), the head of an AdjP, see (26:16), and the head of a NP, see (16:12).

Thetic verbal clauses lack a topical argument as they introduce a new participant into the discourse or focus on the whole situation. Consequently, the arguments follow their VC, see (15).

(15) *Evehee na teitei batana a sii vapara nae.*
evehee na tei~tei bata=na a sii vapara
but TM2 RED~be.there CONT=3SG.IPFV ART2.SG DIM partner
nae
3SG.POSS.PRON
'But usually there is its partner.' (35:12)

Clauses may lack subject and object NPs or Pronouns, if the context provides sufficient information to identify who or what is talked about, see Table 22.

4 The syntactic functions of phrases

The description of the syntactic functions of phrases is divided into two sections: Section 4.1 describes their functions as immediate clause constituents and Section 4.2 describes their functions as subordinate constituents of other phrases. Clause external topics are formed by NPs (24) and PrepPs (2).

4.1 Phrases functioning as immediate clause constituents

Seven types of phrase function as immediate constituents of clauses, see Table 2.

Table 2: Phrases functioning as immediate clause constituents.

PHRASE	FUNCTION AS IMMEDIATE CLAUSE CONSTITUENTS			
	PREDICATE	SUBJECT/OBJECT	OBLIQUE	ADJUNCT
VC	(1), (8)ff	-	-	-
NP	(2)	(1), (3), (4), (5), (8)ff	-	-
AdjP	(4), (5)	-	-	-
LocP	(2)	-	(16)	(1)
PrepP	(6)	-	(17)	(10)
anaphoric NumP	-	(2), (6), (6:35)	-	-
anaphoric SubstP	-	(2), (6), (29:72)	-	-

VCs only function as predicates. They are typically, but not obligatorily marked by particles that signify temporal relations, modality and aspect, see

Section 7.4 and Section 7.5. All other phrase types have more than one function. For the predicative function of NPs, AdjPs, LocPs and PrepPs see Section 2.

NPs function as topical and non-topical subjects of Non-Verbal Clauses, see Section 2, and in Verbal Clauses as topical and non-topical subjects and objects, see Section 3.

Anaphoric NumPs and SubstPs function as topical subjects and non-topial objects.

LocPs and PrepPs function as predicates and as oblique objects that are governed by a VC headed by *tei* 'be somewhere' or by a VC with the incorporated Preposition *vo*^{1} 'to' or *vo*^{2} 'like'.

Oblique objects formed by LocPs or PrepPs typically depend on VCs headed by *tei* 'be somewhere', see (16).

Oblique objects are governed by a VC headed by *tei* 'be somewhere' and by a VC with the incorporated preposition *vo*^{1} 'to' or *vo*^{2} 'like', and are expressed by an Adverb, LocP, or a PrepP. The LocPs or PrepPs governed by *tei* 'be somewhere' refer to any kind of location, be it inside a coconut (5:7) or in the jungle, see (16).

(16) *O kara kuskus na tei nana rasuu,*
o kara_kuskus na tei nana rasuu
ART3.SG passionflower [TM2 be.there 3SG.IPFV]$_{VC}$ jungle
'The passionflower is found in the jungle.' (11:39)

VCs marked by the incorporated preposition *vo* GOAL are mostly headed by a Verb denoting a kind of motion, see (17).

(17) *ore paa kuu gunaha vo maa teo kasuana.*
o=re paa kuu gunaha vo maa te=o
3PL.PRON=CONSEC [TM3 fall go.down GOAL hither]$_{VC}$ PREP=ART3.SG
kasuana
ground
'(When the coconut has become dry high up on a standing coconut palm,) then it falls down to the ground.' (5:3)

The incorporated preposition *vo*^{2} 'like' is most frequently found with the cataphoric adverb *en* 'this' (DEM3) and the anaphoric PrepP *tee=bona* 'this' (PREP=ANA.SG). Typical examples are (5:23) and (5:45).

4.2 Subordinate phrases

VCs and the anaphoric NumPs and SubstPs are not found in subordinate functions, but all other phrases occur as subordinate phrases that are either embedded

in the superordinate phrase or juxtaposed to it. Table 3 below shows the distribution of six phrase types across six subordinate functions. A special phrase type is the Linker Phrase (LnkP) which only functions as a subordinate constituent. The subordinate functions of phrases are:

- the core of a VC, see (34) in Section 7.1;
- the juxtaposed modifier of a Verb or Noun;
- the attribute of a NP;
- the inalienable possessor NP, see Section 10;
- the complement of a Preposition in a PrepP;
- the complement of the Linker of a LnkP

Table 3: Subordinate Phrases.

PHRASE	FUNCTIONS AS SUBORDINATE CONSTITUENTS					
	CORE OF VC	MODIFIER OF V OR N	ATTR. OF NP	INALIEN. POSSESSOR	COMPL. OF PREPOSITION	COMPL. OF LINKER
NP	(18)	-	(25)	(23), (25)	(19)-(22), (24)	-
AdjP	-	-	(3), (14), (26)	-	-	-
NumP	-	-	(2)	-	-	-
LocP	-	-	-	-	-	(23)
PrepP	(19)	-	(22), (24)	-	-	(20)-(22)
LnkP	(20)	(21)-(23)	-	-	-	-

NPs and PrepP that function as the predicate of a non-verbal clause can be negated by the Double Negator *sa(ka) ... haa* (NEG1 ... NEG2) and then function as the core of a VC. In a text about poisoning fish with roots, the author emphasizes that they use many roots, see (18).

(18) *Saka o peho ana haana to tasu raara,*
saka o peho ana haa=na to tasu
[NEG1 ART3.SG one3.SG root NEG=3SG.IPFV]$_{VC}$ REL beat
ra=ara
1PL.IN.IPFV=1PL.IN.PRON
'It is not a single root that we beat (and throw into the pool), ...' (37:15)

Similarly, a PrepP functions as the core of a negated VC to emphasize that turtle netting is not done at the edge of the reef, see (19).

(19) *ei saka tea irihi haana,*
ei saka te=a irihi haa=na
DEM2 [NEG1 [PREP=ART2.SG edge.of.reef]$_{\text{PrepP}}$ NEG2=3SG.IPFV]$_{\text{VC}}$
'(We know the place where the net is thrown or where the turtle netting is done,) this (is) not at the edge of the reef, ...' (28:11)

Thirdly, a LnkP with a PrepP as its complement holds the position of the core of an affirmative VC and means 'be like sth', see (20).

(20) *A kokoroto na vaa tea ahio nana,*
a kokoroto na vaa te=a ahio nana
ART2.SG kokoroto TM2 LNK PREP=ART2.SG ahio 3SG.IPFV
'The *kokoroto* is similar to the *ahio* lizard (but the *ahio* is green, while the *kokoroto* is brown.)' (See https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-kokoroto)

In this text collection the LnkP is used as a modifier of a Verb, see (21),

(21) *o sii vahara vasu beori ravun vaa tea vaakororovi rori.*
o sii vahara vasu be=ori ravun vaa
ART2.PL DIM small.PL stone when=3PL.PRON be.heaped.up LNK
te=a vaakororovi rori
PREP=ART2.SG circle 3PL.IPFV
'(When we are about to catch wrasses, we search for) little stones being heaped up in a circle.' (35:6)

or as a modifier of a Noun[9], see (22).

(22) *O paranda o peho taba vaa tea inu teara ...*
o paranda o peho taba vaa te=a inu
ART3.SG floor ART3.SG INDEF3.SG thing LNK PREP=ART2.SG house
te=ara
PREP=1PL.IN.PRON
'The floor is a thing in our house, ...' (20:1)

Similar to the PrepP in (22), LocPs are linked as a modifier to a Noun, see (23).

[9] In (5:180) *mene vaanoto suraa vaa tea taotao* 'in order to light the fire for baking (food) in the earth oven' the LnkP modifies the Noun *suraa* 'fire' which functions as the complement of the transitive verb *vaanoto* 'light'.

(23) *a vana vaa komana overe*
a vana vaa koma-n=a overe
ART3.PL germinating.leaf LNK inside-3SG.POSS=ART2.SG coconut
'the germinating leaves inside the coconut' (5:24)

In NPs referring to the stages of work processes, the Linker connects a Complement Clause to the head, e.g. *a kiu vaa tea* V... 'the work of doing V', see Section 11. When a PrepP introduced by *te* (PREP) directly follows a NP as its attribute, it always refers to an alienable possessor, see (24).

(24) *A kara bao, eve a tabaan teo burumakao.*
a kara bao eve a tabaan te=o burumakao
ART3.PL string grass 3SG.PRON [ART2.SG food PREP=ART2.PL cow]$_{NP}$
'Grass is the food of cows.' (11:11)

In the Inalienable Possessive Constructions (23) and (25), the head Noun is marked by the suffixed Possessive Marker (POSS) which indexes the person and number category of the following possessor NP, see Section 10. Attributive NPs modify the meaning of a preceding NP marked by *vai* 'this' (DEM6), see (25).[10]

(25) *O naono vai o kopihoo na paku riori bono aga no sinivi.*
o naono vai o kopihoo na paku ri=ori
ART3.SG tree DEM6 ART3.SG kopihoo TM2 make 3PL.IPFV=3PL.PRON
bono aga n=o sinivi
OBJ.ART3.SG float 3SG.POSS=ART3.SG canoe
'The *kopihoo* tree is used for making the float of the outrigger canoe.' (23:2)

NPs followed by an attributive AdjP are optionally marked by *vai* 'this' (DEM6) to distinguish the attriutive AdjP from the predicative one, see (26), and compare it with (4) above.

(26) *A koopu vai a mataa ae bebeahu na teitei nana rasuu.*
a koopu vai a mataa ae bebeahu na tei~tei
ART3.PL bamboo DEM6 ART3.PL good and1 long TM2 RED~be.there
nana rasuu
3SG.IPFV jungle
'The good and long *koopu* bamboos are in the jungle.' (19:6)

[10]Similar examples are (6:2) and (7:4)

5 The classification of content words and Numerals

5.1 Introduction

This section deals with Nouns (N), Verbs (V), Adjectives (Adj), Cardinal Numerals (Num)[11] and Manner Adverbs (Adv) that are derived by the prefix *va-* 'ADVR'. Their classification is based on the combination of two criteria:

1. their function as heads of VCs, NPs, AdjPs, and NumPs;
2. their compatibility with directly following content words as their modifiers.

LocPs are not considered in this section, because they are exclusively headed by Nouns referring to a specific place. A special subclass of Nouns which denote specific kinds of plurality are dealt with in Section 8.3. The most frequent Noun of this kind is the Plural Marker *maa* 'PLM' denoting distributional plurality. For details of the distinction of Teop Nouns, Verbs, and Adjectives see Mosel (2017), for lexical flexibility in Oceanic languages van Lier (2016), and for word classification in Austronesian languages Mosel (2023).

5.2 The function of content words and Numerals as phrasal heads

Verbs and Adjectives occur as the head of VCs, NPs, and AdjPs, whereas Nouns only head VCs and NPs. But Verbs differ from Adjectives in their selection of modifiers, see Section 5.3. Cardinal Numerals function as the head of VCs and NumPs. Adverbs are not found in the position of a phrasal head, see Table 4.

Table 4: Content words and Numerals functioning as the head of VCs, NPs, AdjP, and NumPs.

WORD CLASSES	VC	NP	AdjP	NumP
V	(27b)	(27a), (28), (29)	(30b), (38)	-
N	(31)	(28), (27b)	-	-
Adj	(28)	(81b)	(30a), (81a)	-
Num	(32)	-	-	(27a), (33)

NPs headed by a Verb have the same syntactic properties as NPs headed by a Noun with respect to attributive NumPs, see (27).

[11] Other Numerals are derived from Cardinal Numerals, e.g. *vaa-buaku* 'second' (20:18), *bubuaku* 'in pairs', and *va-buaku* 'two together' (29:63).

(27) a. *A kukan bau gea dorana a hovu,*
a kukan bau ge=a dorana a hovu
[ART2.SG three perhaps or=ART2.SG four]$_{NumP}$ [ART2.SG husk]$_{NP}$
'Perhaps three or four husking movements, and then the coconut is completely husked.'

b. *a overe repaa tahovu vakavara.*
a overe re=paa ta-hovu va-kavara
ART2.SG coconut CONSEC=TM3 ACAUS-husk ADVR-complete
'(and) then the coconut is completely husked.' (5:62)

When the NP head is formed by a transitive Verb, it functions as the possessum of an Inalienable Possessive Construction (Section 10), see (28).

(28) *A koro no komano sinivi potee na varuruva koana*
a koro n=o koma-n=o sinivi
[ART2.SG carve.out 3SG.POSS=ART3.SG inside-3SG.POSS=ART3.SG canoe
potee na varuruva koa=na
potee]$_{NP}$ [TM2 easy just=3SG.IPFV]$_{VC}$
'The carving of the inside of the *potee* canoe is quite easy.' (24:14)

But within the NP, a Verb is modified by an Adverb and not by an Adjective, see (29).

(29) *ahiki ta popo vatamaka*
ahiki ta popo va-tamaka
not.exist NSPEC2.SG live ADVR-sad
'there was not any sad life'
(See https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-vatamaka)

Similarly, Verbs heading an AdjP are modified by adverbs as, for instance, *kare* 'recently', see (30).

(30) a. *O baneo vai o visoasi,*
o baneo vai o visoasi
ART3.SG breadfruit_tree DEM6 ART3.SG young
'The young breadfruit tree'

b. *o baneo vai o kare pura,*
o baneo vai o kare pura
ART3.SG breadfruit_tree DEM6 [ART3.SG recently grow]$_{AdjP}$
'is a breadfruit tree that has only recently started growing, ...' (8:1)

Nouns heading a VC are modified by Adjectives, see (31).

(31) *O naono vai o sinivi na taba beera kurusu kiri nana bona tavaan,*
o naono vai o sinivi na taba beera kurusu
ART3.SG tree DEM6 ART3.SG sinivi [TM2 thing important very
ki=ri nana bona tavaan
DAT=3PL.OBJM 3SG.IPFV]$_{VC}$ OBJ.ART2.SG people
'This canoe tree is a very important thing for the people, ...' (7:4)

Adjectives function as the head of AdjPs (30a), VCs (28), and Inalienable Possessive NPs, see Section 10.

Cardinal numerals function as the head of VCs, see (32),

(32) *Enam paa dorana vaevuru.*
e-nam paa dorana vaevuru
H-1PL.EX.PRON TM3 four already
'We were already four.' (See https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-dorana)

and as the head of NumPs functioning as an attribute or an anaphoric argument, see (33).

(33) a. *Teo dorana o pakapaka,*
te=o dorana o pakapaka
PREP=ART3.SG four ART3.SG flipper
'As for the four flippers (of the turtle),'

b. *o buaku vaa kahoo nae na dao raara bono huahua.*
o buaku vaa kahoo nae na dao
ART3.SG two LNK head- 3SG.POSS.PRON TM2 call
ra=ara bono hua~hua
1PL.IN.IPFV=1PL.IN.PRON OBJ.ART3.SG RED~paddle
'the two near its head, we call paddles.' (26:6)

In (33b) the NumP *o buaku* 'the two' is classified as an anaphoric NumP functioning as a topical primary object, because the selection of its Article *o* 'ART3.SG' is determined by the head of the preceding NP *o dorana o pakapaka* 'the four flippers'.

5.3 The modification of content words by other juxtaposed content words

The term modifier is used for content words that directly follow another content word and characterize the concept denoted by the preceding word. Not considered as modifiers are content words functioning as a secondary predication,

e.g. *avuhu mataa* 'smell good' (5:139), or as a juxtaposed complement of a relational Noun, e.g. NN: *kaku vagana* 'kind of fishing' (10), or a transitive Verb, e.g. VN: *paku sinivi* 'make (a) canoe' (7:14), VV: *vaanagu koava* 'resist rotting' (16:8), VNum: *gae kukan* 'lift three (bamboo strips)' (19:35). Verbs, Nouns, Adjectives and numerals are distinct from one another with respect to their modification by content words. While Numerals do not have any modifiers, Verbs, Nouns and Adjectives differ in their selection of modifying content words, see Table 5.

Table 5: The compatibility of Verbs, Nouns and Adjectives with juxtaposed modifiers.

	Modifiers			
	V	N	Adj	Adv
V	(5:3)	(22:23)	-	(10:30)
N	(16:1)	(5:20)	(7:4)	-
Adj	(30:18)	-	-	(27:14)

Verbs can be modified by Verbs, Nouns and Adverbs, see Table 6.

Table 6: The modification of Verbs.

	text	gloss	translation	ref
V V	*kuu gunaha*	fall go.down	'fall down'	(17)
V N	*paku vaagum*	do group	'do sth in a group'	(22:23)
V Adv	*pura va-mataa*	grow ADVR-good	'grow well'	(10:30)

Nouns only differ from Verbs in being modified by an Adjective instead of an Adverb, see Table 7.

Table 7: The modification of Nouns.

	text	gloss	translation	ref
N V	*inu goro~goroho*	house RED~sleep	'sleeping house'	(16:1)
N N	*paka overe*	leaf coconut.palm	'coconut leaf'	(5:20)
N Adj	*taba beera*	thing big/important	'important thing'	(31)

Table 8: Adjectives modified by Verbs and Adverbs.

	TEXT	GLOSS	TRANSLATION	REF
Adj V	*beera oha*	big exceed	'bigger than'	(30:18)
	beera potee	big be.like	'as big as'	(24:5)
Adj Adv	*bebeahu va-antee*	long ADVR-enough	'long enough'	(27:14)
	paru va-pereperee	black ADVR-green	'greenish black'	MTED[a]

[a]https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-paru_vapereperee and https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-vapereperee.

Similar to Verbs, Adjectives are modified by Verbs and Adverbs, but it is only the three verbs *oha* 'exceed,' *potee* 'be like,' and *vaapeha* 'be the same' and a few adverbs. In contrast to Verbs, AdjPs are not modified by Nouns, see Table 8.

The selection of modifiers is independent of the syntactic function of the modified content word. In (29) the Verb *popo* 'live' heads a NP and is modified by the adverb *vatamaka* 'sadly', and in (31) the prototypical Noun *taba* 'thing' functions as the head of a VC and is modified by the Adjective *beera* 'big, important'.

6 The morphology

The inflectional morphology is restricted to the Articles (Section 8.2), the Numerals *peha*^{1}/*peho*^{1} 'one' and bua/buo 'two', the Indefinite Determiner *peha*^{2}/*peho*^{2}, the Determiner *meha*/*meho* 'other, some' within the NP (Section 8.4), to the person forms of the Object Marker (Section 7.1) and the Imperfective Aspect Marker in the VC (Section 7.5), and to the Pronouns (Section 9) and the Possessive Marker in Inalienable Possessive Constructions (Section 10).

The derivational morphology is restricted to seven affixes and reduplication:[12]

- ACAUS-: the Anticausative prefix *ta-* derives intransitive Verbs from transitive ones.
- -ADJR: the suffix *-ana* derives Adjectives from reduplicated Nouns. The form RED~N-*ana* means 'full of N', e.g., *usu~usu-ana* 'full of lice'.

[12]For examples see Mosel et al. (2007a: 258–260) or Search (Words extra) in the MTED for the Gloss. If you search for causatives, insert "^CAUS", the graph "^" means: the beginning of the entry.

- ADVR-: the Prefix *va-* derives Adverbs from Adjectives and some stative Verbs
- CAUS-: the Prefix *vaa-*, *va-* derives transitive causative Verbs and some intransitive Verbs with various meanings.
- -DEREL: the Derelational suffix *-na* derives non-relational nouns from relational nouns, see Section 10.
- MULT-: the Prefix *va-* derives Verbs denoting multiple actions, including reciprocal actions.
- ORD-: the Ordinal prefix *vaa-* derives Ordinal Numerals from Cardinal Numerals.
- RED~: Reduplication signifies various kinds of plurality and derives Adjectives from Nouns or other adjectives, e.g. *pere~peree* 'green' from *peree* 'unripe'.

In accordance with the multifunctionality of Verbs and Nouns, Teop lacks morphemes that derive Nouns from Verbs or Verbs from Nouns.

7 The Verb Complex (VC)

7.1 Introduction

The VC is the only type of phrase that exclusively functions as a predicate, see Section 4.1. The head of canonical VCs is formed by a Verb, a Noun or an Adjective; for non-canonical VCs see Section 4.2. The sequential order of functional and lexical words in VCs is fixed, see (34).

(34) NEG1 TM [Adv_1 HEAD X Adv_2]$_{CORE}$ NEG2 APPL Prep OBJM Adv_3 IPFV/PFV

In (34) X stands for content words that follow the head as modifiers, complements or secondary predications, see Section 5.3 and the modifying LnkP, see Section 4.2. The abbreviations Adv_1, Adv_2, and Adv_3 indicate the three positions of Adverbs. The first position is held by *pahin* 'immediately' (22:24) or *manin* 'ever' in negated VCs, see (11:63).[13] In contrast, the second position can be held by more than one adverb, see (35).

[13]Further examples of Adverbs in this position are *pate*^{2} 'together' and *van* 'together', search for these Headwords in the MTED.

(35) *O koverau saka tau pura vatotobin tamuana bata haana.*
o koverau saka tau pura va-totobin tamuana bata
ART3.SG koverau NEG1 TM5 grow ADVR-straight always CONT
haa=na
NEG2=3SG.IPFV
'The *koverau* bamboo might not always continuously grow straight.' (10:2)

The third Adv-position can be held by *maa* 'hither' or *nao* 'thither' and roho 'before', which may occur together as in (37) *deedee maa roho* 'brought be here'.

The functional words of the VC are:

1. the Double Negator (18), (19), (35);
2. the pre-head TM-Markers signifying temporal relations and modality, e.g. *tau* TM5 (35), see Section 7.4;
3. the post-head Applicative Particle *ni* APPL signifying that the VC is transitive, see Section 7.2;
4. post-head incorporated Prepositions which increase the valency of the VC core, see Section 7.3;
5. the post-head Object Markers (OBJM) which index direct and primary object NPs and Pronouns, i.e. the uninflected Object Marker *a* OBJM (47), *ara* 1PL.IN.OBJM (43), and *ri* 3PL.OBJM (31), (39c), (68), (70);
6. the post-head Aspect Markers (IPFV, PFV) occur in the last position of the VC, see Section 7.5.

There are three kinds of Hybrid VCs:

1. a negated VC in which the core is formed by a NP or PrepPs, see Section 3;
2. an affirmative VC with a LnkP as its core, see Section 3, and
3. a VC in which the core is formed by Noun and the Demonstrative *vai* 'this' (DEM6), and then beyond its borderline followed by an modifying AdjP or Relative Clause. Examples are found in (16:11), (20:8) and (31:5).

In certain contexts such as Imperative Constructions, Adverbial Clauses, and Relative Clauses the VC may only consist of a single Verb, see (26:40), (5:4), and (75).

7.2 The Applicative Particle

Irrespective of the valency of the VC core, the Applicative Particle marks the valency of a VC as transitive, see Mosel (2010: 493–496)[14], see (36).

(36) *A ba suburaara na booboha overe ni roho bona vasu.*
a ba subu-raara na booboha
ART2.SG KIN.PLM grandparent-1PL.IN.POSS.PRON [TM2 [[break$_{TR}$
overe ni roho bona vasu
coconut]$_{INTR}$ APPL]$_{TR}$ before]$_{VC}$ [OBJ.ART2.SG stone]$_{INS}$
'Our grandparents broke coconuts (by hitting them) with a stone, ...' (5:69)

The Applicative Particle marks the valency of a VC as transitive. In (36) the transitive Verb *booboha* 'break' is followed by *overe* 'coconut' functioning as its complement. This intransitive construction *booboha overe* 'break coconuts' is then transitivized by the Applicative Particle *ni* APPL, e.g. *booboha overe ni* 'break coconuts with sth.' Further examples of this frequently used construction are listed in Table 9.

Table 9: Transitive VCs of the structure V $N_{PATIENT}$ APPL $NP_{INSTRUMENT}$.

TEXT	TRANSLATION	REF
kuukuhi overe ni	'grate coconuts with (a shell)'	(1)
vaanoto suraa ni	'light fire with (the fibrous husk)'	(5:119)
vigu inu ni	'use (the sago palm) for building houses'	(6:54)
isuisuvu ruene ni	'use (the *kururu* bamboo) for fetching water'	(10:24)
paku vavaatoa ni	'do kite fishing with (*ariono* vines)'	(11:9)

If a VC is headed by the ditransitive Verb like *hee* 'give sb. sth.' and marked by *ni*, the VC is transitive, e.g. *hee hiava ni* [give go.up APPL] 'reach sth. up', (6:40), (17:37).

7.3 Incorporated Prepositions

The incorporation of Prepositions in VCs is a means of increasing the valency of the VC core (see Mosel 2000). The VC is mostly headed by a Verb, see Table 10.

[14]Search (Words) in the MTED for the MWE "vi - appl" and find 123 entries with the Part of Speech "vt.constr". Then search for the MWE "vd - appl" and find 14 entries with the Part of Speech "vt.constr".

Table 10: VCs headed by a Verb with incorporated prepositions.

TEXT	GLOSS OF PREP	TRANSLATION	REF
neba ki	DAT	'plant sth. for (cows)'	(39c)
sue ki	DAT	'tell sb.'	(22:20)
rova kahi	from	'disappear from'	(26:34)(47)
tei me	with	'have sth.' (lit. 'be there with sth.')	(26:4)(81b)
kuu gunaha vo	GOAL	'fall down to'	(17)

But there are also examples of VCs with incorporated prepositions that are headed by an Adjective or a Noun, see Table 11.

Table 11: VCs headed by an Adjective or Noun with an incorporated preposition.

TEXT	GLOSS OF PREP	TRANSLATION	REF
mataa ki	DAT	'be good for sb.'	(16:7)
mataa suku	because.of	'be good because of sth.'	(11:72)
taba beera ki	DAT	'be an important thing for sb.'	(31)

7.4 The TM-Markers signifying temporal relations and modality

Eight prehead TM-Markers signify how the situation described by the VC is located in time with respect to some other past, present or future situation given by the context and its modality. The TM-Markers are listed below with short meaning descriptions, and their frequencies in this text collection in square brackets, see Table 12.

The numbers of the glosses TM1–TM8 do not have any meaning as they were given to the particles at the beginning of the Teop language project.

The frequency and distribution of the TM-Markers in this text collection is obviously influenced by its genre, as most clauses make generic statements about plants and the stages of work processes. Even the making of the turtle fishing net that hasn't been practiced since the 1980s is described as a timeless practice. Statements about specific events of the past are rare.

The Realis Marker *na* TM2 occurs 234 times, but only four times in VCs without the IPFV Marker. Two of them are about past practices in (1) and (36). The third one is about a single past event, see (37).

(37) *O karaa vai o hiki toutou na deedee maa rohori Solomon*
o karaa vai o hiki toutou na dee~dee maa
ART3.SG pandanus DEM6 ART3.SG not.have thorns [TM2 RED~carry hither
roho ori solomon
before]$_{VC}$ 3PL.PRON Solomon
'The pandanus without thorns was brought from the Solomon Islands.'
(13:17)

Table 12: The TM-markers and their meanings.

TM	GLOSS	NAME AND MEANING	TOKENS
paa	TM3	Change-of-Situation Marker: This situation followed, will follow, or generally follows another situation.	452 tokens
na	TM2	Realis Marker: This situation is a fact that occurred before the utterance or before some other past situation. The construction TM2-Head-IPFV means that the situation is or was simultaneous with the present or a past situation.	234 tokens
toro	TM7	Necessity Marker: This situation is/was necessary, obligatory or inevitable.	86 tokens
kahi	TM1	Posterior Marker1: This situation is/was expected to occur.	41 tokens
pasi	TM4	Posterior Marker2: This situation is or was wanted to occur.	33 tokens
tau	TM5	Posterior Marker3: This situation is or was about to happen.	23 tokens
mene	TM6	Timitive Marker:[a] This frightening situation might happen or might have happened.	9 tokens
pari	TM8	Counterfactual Marker: This situation almost happened.[b]	no tokens

[a]The adjective "timitive" has been created by Palmer "for fears" (2001: 133-134) and is used by Lichtenberk in his article "Modality and Mood in Oceanic languages," (2016: 346–349).
[b]In the MTED the TM-Marker *pari* is classified as an Adverb.

The fourth one occurs in a procedural text in a clause about an action that was done before the current referent time, see (38).

(38) *ei kou na kaku pisi momohu ara.*
ei kou na kaku pisi momohu ara
because TM2 break fold first 1PL.IN.PRON
'(We put the bamboo strip on the ground, then we open a sago-palm leaf,) because we had folded it before.' (17:23)

Past events are also expressed by non-verbal predicates, by VCs without any TM-Marker, and by VCs that are marked by any of the other TM-Markers as, for example, the Change of Situation Marker *paa* TM3, which has the highest frequency of TM-Markers, see (39).

(39) a. *Nabunuu roho enam ahiki to kara bao.*
nabunuu roho e-nam ahiki to kara bao[15]
in.the.past before H-1PL.EX.PRON not.exist NSPEC3.SG grass
'(Grass is the food of cows.) In the past we did not have any grass.'

b. *O burumakao he nomaa koa*
o burumakao he nomaa koa
ART2.PL cattle ADVERS come just
'But the cows came,'

c. *meori paa ma neba bata kiri bari bono kara bao.*
me=ori paa ma neba bata ki=ri bari
and4=3PL.PRON [TM3 come plant CONT DAT=3PL.OBJM]$_{VC}$ 4.PL.PRON
bono kara bao
OBJ.ART3.SG grass
'and they planted the grass for them.' (11:12-13)

A similar sequence of clauses about the past is Naphtali Maion's text about the past practice of *kaku goroto* 'butchering turtles' in (26:31-33).

The following text excerpt illustrates the changes of temporal relations and modality in four subsequent clauses. The text describes what a man should do when he has carved the hull of a canoe in the jungle and now wants some men to pull it to the village, see (40).

[15]For subordinate clauses functioning as predicates see Section 11.

(40) a. *Evehee ean toro paku a sii tabaan*
evehee e-an toro paku a sii tabaan
but H-2SG.PRON TM7 make ART2.SG DIM food
'(..., you tell some people to assist you to pull it home. This work does not cost anything,) But you should make some food'

b. *to kahi ma an koa vue o manae*
to kahi ma an koa vue o manae
REL TM1 come eat just particulary ART2.PL young.men
'that the young men will eat,'

c. *to paa nao nau tea rahi sinivi.*
to paa nao na=u tea rahi sinivi
REL TM3 go thither=PFV COMPL1 pull canoe
'who have gone there to pull the canoe.' (24:36)

Each of the four clauses of (40) has a distinct reference time that is given by the preceding context. In (40c) the Change-of-Situation Marker *paa* (TM3) signifies that the situation of going (into the jungle) follows the situation of 'you tell some people', whereas the PFV-Marker signifies that it precedes the situation of pulling the canoe.

The next example illustrates the use of the two Posteriority Markers *tau* TM5 'be about to', *pasi* TM4, and again the Necessity Marker *toro* TM7 'must'. The Posteriority Marker2 *pasi* (TM4) is combined with the IPFV Marker to signify habituality.[16] As in (40) the reference times (RefTs) change from clause to clause, see (41).

(41) a. *Beara tau nao tea suvasuva,*
be=ara tau nao tea suva~suva
when=1PL.IN.PRON TM5 go COMPL1 RED~poison
'Before we go to poison fish,'

b. *eara toro matatopo amaa taba*
e-ara toro matatopo a=maa taba
H-1PL.IN.PRON TM7 prepare ART2.SG=PLM taba
'we must prepare the things'

[16]There is no example of *pasi* TM4 without an aspect marker in this text collection. For the use of *pasi* without the IPFV Marker and further information see https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-pasi.

c. *to pasi dee raara.*
to pasi dee ra=ara
REL TM4 take 1PL.IN.IPFV=1PL.IN.PRON
'that we'll take there.' (37:3)

The use of the Timitive Marker *mene* TM6 is illustrated by a VC headed by *hiki* 'not have', see (42).

(42) a. *Meara toro kikira nio naosinivi,*
me=ara toro kikira ni=o nao-sinivi
and4=1PL.IN.PRON TM7 look.after APPL=ART3.SG tree-canoe
'We must look after the canoe tree,'

b. *eara mene hiki sinivi.*
e-ara mene hiki sinivi
H-1PL.IN.PRON TM6 not.have canoe
'otherwise we would not have canoes.' (7:16)

7.5 The Aspect Markers

The Imperfective-Marker (IPFV) and the Perfective-Marker (PFV) hold the last position of the VC and exclude each other. The IPFV Marker inflects for person and number, see Table 13.

Table 13: The Imperfective and the Perfective Aspect Markers and their meanings.

ASPECT MARKER	GLOSS	MEANING
nom *nana*, *=na*, *na=* *rara*, *=ra*, *ra=* *rori*, *=ri*, *ri=*	IPFV 3SG.IPFV 1PL.IN.IPFV 3PL.IPFV	The situation is timeless, or it lasts for some time and includes the utterance time or the situation time of some other situation before or after the utterance time.
=(v)u, *=v=*	PFV[a]	The situation is, was, will or could be completed and is relevant to a subsequent situation.

[a] In the MTED the Perfective Aspect Marker (PFV) is called Immediateness Marker and glossed by IMM, because we thought that this marker only signified that a situation that is relevant for an immediately subsequent situation.

The IPFV Marker indexes the subject NP or Pronoun as in (41c) unless a 1st or 2nd person Pronoun functions as the object and a NP or 3rd person Pronoun as the subject. Then it indexes the object Pronoun, see (43).

(43) *me eve kahi ani vakavakavara kurusu araraara*
me eve kahi ani va-kava~kavara kurusu
and4 3SG.PRON TM1 eat CAUS-RED~finished indeed
ara=ra=ara
1PL.IN.OBJM=1PL.IN.IPFV=1PL.IN.PRON
'and he is going to eat us all.' (0513_DoReCo_doreco_teop1238_Sii_06, in Mosel (2024))

The 3rd person plural IPFV Marker regularly indexes subject plural Pronouns and NPs with human referents as in (9), (14), but sometimes also things and animals that play an important role in their context, see (30:8).

The form *nom* indexes 1SG, 1PL.EX., 2SG, and 2PL subject Pronouns, but is simply glossed by IPFV, because it may also index 1PL.IN, 3SG and 3PL arguments, if the pre-head TM marker is not the Realis Marker *na* TM2, see (44).

(44) *A bua kehaa bona to kahi ato vamasuu bata ni nom bona kave*
a bua kehaa bona to kahi ato va-masuu bata ni
ART2.SG two2.SG[17] shell ANA.SG REL [TM1 hold ADVR-steady CONT APPL
nom bona kave
IPFV]$_{VC}$ OBJ.ART2.SG net
'These two shells (i.e. heavy helmet shells) will hold the net steady.' (27:29)

The clitic forms of the IPFV and PFV Markers are attached to words preceding them within the VC or to a word directly following them beyond the VC.[18]

TM Markers combine with Aspect Markers in various ways, but they may also occur without any Aspect Markers, and IPFV Markers may lack a TM marker, see Table 14.

The VC of relative clauses obligatorily lacks the Realis Marker *na* TM2, so that only the IPFV Marker marks it to express habitual situations, see (45).

[17] See: https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-bua.

[18] Search (Words extra) in the MTED for the Gloss "IPFV" and find 84 entries. Then search for the Gloss "IMM" and find 46 entries for the PFV Marker.

Table 14: The distribution of TM Markers Aspect Markers.

	GLOSS	V	V - IPFV	V - PFV
paa	TM3	(8), (12), (17), (27b), (39c)	(17:44), (24:38)	(40c), (47), (27:20)
na	TM2	(36), (37), (38)	(1), (9), (11), (13)-(15)	-
toro	TM7	(40a), (41b), (42a)	(5:151)	-[a]
kahi	TM1	(40b)	(43), (44)	(48), (30:15)
pasi	TM2	other texts[b]	(41c), (17:19)	(49), (35:8)
tau	TM5	(41a)	(35)	-
mene	TM6	(42b)	(27:30)	-
∅	TM	(39b), (19:17)	(45), (46), (6:5)	-

[a] In other texts *tau* TM4, *toro* TM7 and *mene* TM6 are found in VCs, but they precede the TM3-V-PFV-Construction, e.g. *enaa tau paa gono=u* 'I was about to get ...'
[b] See https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-pasi.

(45) *A rupi a bero kurusu to vahuhu nana a goroto.*
a rupi a bero kurusu to vahuhu nana a goroto
ART3.PL egg ART3.PL many very REL lay.eggs 3SG.IPFV ART2.SG turtle
'The turtle lays many eggs indeed.' (26:16)

Further types of clause in which the VC obligatorily lacks the Realis Marker *na* TM2, but may be marked for the imperfective aspect are the clauses with the Double Negator (5:6), Adverbial Clauses (6:5), Complement clauses (5:9), and Imperative Clauses, see (46).

(46) *Kikira vakikis bata koa ni nom eve.*
kiikira va-kikis bata koa ni nom eve
watch ADVR-strong CONT just APPL IPFV 3SG.PRON
'Just keep carefully watching it.' (35:18)

The PFV-Marker combines most frequently with the Change-of-Situation Marker *paa* TM3. If the reference time is simultaneous with utterance time, the clause refers to a past event that is still relevant, see (47).

(47) *Nomana amaa matapaku vai paa rova kahi avuaraara.*
nomana a=maa matapaku vai paa rova kahi
today ART2.SG=PLM practice DEM6 TM3 disappear from
a=vu=araara
OBJM=PFV=1PL.IN.OBJ.PRON
'Today these practices have disappeared from us.' (26:34)

When the PFV-Marker combines with the Posteriority Marker *kahi* TM1, the event is located after the RefT and relevant for a following event, see (48).

(48) *me kahi huha vuara bona maa bon amaa bero.*
me kahi huha vu=ara bona maa bon a=maa
and4 TM1 tie PFV=1PL.IN.PRON OBJ.ART2.SG PLM day ART2.SG=PLM
bero
many
'(The work is big,) and we will tie (the net) many days.' (27:23)

The same kind of temporal relation is signified by the Posteriority Marker *pasi* TM4 in combination with the PFV-Marker, see (49).

(49) *O dorana o naono pasi vaasun vori,*
o dorana o naono pasi vaa-sun v=ori
ART3.SG four ART3.SG pole TM4 CAUS-stand PFV=3PL.PRON
'They will put up four poles, (and then they lay another four poles across, ...)' (6:34)

8 The Noun Phrase (NP)

8.1 Introduction

NPs are marked by an Article which holds the first position of the phrase and is only dropped in the fixed expressions, e.g. *meha maa vuri* 'sometimes' (lit. 'other times'), *meha papana* 'other people, others' (lit. 'other group') at the beginning of a clause.[19] NPs are headed by a Noun, a Verb, and rarely by an Adjective. The head may be preceded by additional determiners and followed by other content words. The last position of the NP is optionally held by the Anaphoric Demonstrative or another kind of Demonstrative. The sequential order of the constituents of basic NPs is shown in (50).

(50) [ART determiners specifiers HEAD X ANA/DEM]$_{NP}$

The Article signifies the lexical class of the head of the NP, which is different from its word class, and the specificity and grammatical number category of the NP. The paradigm of the Articles is presented in Section 8.2, and the classification of NP heads is described in Section 8.3. Then Section 8.4 deals with pre-head

[19] See (5:83), (5:144).

determiners and other words that follow the Article and further specify the reference of the NP.

The post-head position X can be held by a modifying content word, see Section 5.3, a modifying LnkP (Section 4.2) or a content word functioning as the complement of a relational NP head, see Table 15.

Table 15: Relational Nouns and Verbs with complements in NPs.

	TEXT	TRANSLATION	REF
ART N V	*o kaku vagana*	'a kind of fishing'	(10)
OBJ.ART N N	*bene ta boon*	'piece of mangrove wood'	(13)
ART V N	*a deedee overe*	'the carrying of coconuts'	(5:157)

NPs can be preceded by an attributive NumP and followed an attributive NP, AdjP, or PrepP, see Section 4.2. If the NP head is marked by the Possessive Marker, it is followed by a possessor NP or Pronoun, see Section 10.

NPs preceded by NumP or containing the pre-head Numeral *bua*/*bua* 'two' are grammatically singular, see Section 8.4. Furthermore, NPs and Pronouns referring to inanimate objects are mostly grammatically singular forms.

8.2 The paradigm of Articles

The paradigm of Teop Articles distinguishes the three classes of NP heads, singular and plural of the NP and its specific or non-specific reference, see Table 16.

If the Specific Article precedes a NP in a non-predicative function, the NP refers to an entity that is identifiable by the speech situation or the context. The Specific Object Article marks a non-topical object NP in clauses with a 3rd person topical argument, see Section 3.

A predicative NP with a Specific Article states that its referent is identical with the referent of the subject NP or Pronoun, see (51),

(51) *O haopi a hena na iana ...*
o haopi a hena n=a iana
ART3.SG wrasse ART2.SG name 3SG.POSS=ART2.SG fish
'Haopi (Wrasse) is the name of a fish (that stays underground).' (35:1)

or that the subject referent belongs to a specific kind of entity, see (52).

Table 16: Relational Nouns and Verbs with complements in NPs.

	GLOSS	ART1		ART2		ART3	
		SG	PL	SG	PL[a]	SG	PL
Specific Basic Article	ART	*e*	*ere, o*	*a*	*o*	*o*	*a*
Specific Object Article	OBJ.ART	*bene*[b], *bone*	*bere, benere*	*bona*	*bono*	*bono*	*bona*
Non-specific Article	NSPEC	-	-	*ta*	*to*	*to*	*ta*
Partitive Article	PART.ART	*sa*[c]	sa	sa	sa	sa	sa

[a]For the "inverse number marking" of 2nd class Nouns and 3rd class Nouns by Articles see Corbett (2000: 159–166) who also discusses this number marking in Teop (pp. 164-165).
[b]The Article *bene* is also used with reflexive pronouns, search the MTED Headword for "^bene".
[c]See: https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-sa_1.

(52) *A goroto a iana ...*
a goroto a iana
ART2.SG turtle ART2.SG swimming.animal
'The turtle is a swimming animal ...' (26:2)

The plural form *ere* ART1.PL marks associative plurality, e.g. *ere iaa* 'my mother and my aunts'[20]; it is not found in this text collection. The plural forms of the 2nd and 3rd class of specific and non-specific Articles denote groups of entities as, for example, the young breadfruit trees that are used for turtle nets, see (53).

(53) *A naono baneo vai a rutarutaa na mataa nana, ...*
a naono baneo vai a ruta~rutaa na mataa nana
ART3.PL tree breadfruit DEM6 ART3.PL RED~small TM2 good 3SG.IPFV
'The small breadfruit trees are good (because they are moist).' (8:12)

Distributional plurality, i.e. the distribution of objects over space or time as in (54) and (55) below, is expressed by NPs headed by the Plural Marker *maa*, see Section 8.3.

The Non-Specific Article (NSPEC) marks NPs denoting entities whose existence or presence is denied, see (54),

[20]See: https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-ere, also (Mosel 2014b: 66–67), (Corbett 2000: 84, 101), and (Daniel & Moravcsik 2013).

(54) *Amaa hum bona kou na hiki nana to vasu, ...*
a=maa hum bona kou na hiki nana to vasu
ART2.SG=PLM place ANA.SG EMPH2 TM2 not.exist 3SG.IPFV NSPEC2.PL stone
'(And the turtle netting places ... are Taenaruene, Teopasuna, Teanin.)
These places do not have any stones, (just white sand).' (28:15)

or entities whose particular identity is not known yet, see (55).

(55) *ta maa naono baneo vai ta maa rutarutaa.*
ta maa naono baneo vai ta maa ruta~rutaa
NSPEC2.SG PLM tree breadfruit DEM6 NSPEC2.SG PLM RED~small
'(You must go and cut) some small breadfruit trees.' (8:7)

The Partitive Article *sa* 'some' (PART.ART) signifies that the NP refers to some or any part of a whole, see (56).

(56) *Na pakupaku raara bona kanono ae a iri ae sa taba sa ponisi mene dee gunaha bona kanono.*
na paku~paku ra=ara bona kanono ae
TM2 RED~do 1PL.IN.IPFV=1PL.IN.PRON OBJ.ART2.SG string and1
a iri ae sa taba sa ponisi mene dee gunaha
ART2.SG hook and1 PART.ART thing PART.ART heavy for get go.down
bona kanono
OBJ.ART2.SG string
'(We do the angling with a string and a hook) and something heavy to get the string down.' (33:2)

The examples (53), (55) and (56) also illustrate that AdjPs are marked by an Article of the same kind of specificity, class and number as the NP they relate to as an attribute.

The Articles do not distinguish between definite and indefinite NPs. Indefiniteness can be optionally marked by the Indefiniteness Marker, see Section 8.4, and definiteness by the Anaphoric Demonstratives *bona* (ANA.SG) and *bari* (ANA.PL).

8.3 The Articles and the classification of NP heads

Nouns, Verbs and Adjectives heading a NP are classified with respect to their compatibility with one or two of the three Article classes. Their classification

shows some variation, which is determined by certain grammatical constructions or a speaker's individual choice. In the MTED the classification of Nouns is indicated in the Part of Speech field.[21] It is largely predictable:

- N1: Proper names of people, kinship terms, Nouns denoting social roles, and domestic animals.[22]
- N2: Nouns denoting kinds of human beings, vertebrates, invertebrates with legs, landmarks, food items, and parts of a whole; collective Nouns and four words denoting distinct kinds of plurality, see below.
- N3: Nouns denoting plants, parts of plants, and many things made of plant materials. Relational Nouns that are derelationalized by the suffix *na* DEREL, see Section 10.
- N1/N2: animal names of the N2 class are shifted to the N1 class when the animals figure as protagonists in folk stories. The Noun *ta* 'piece', e.g. *bene ta boon* 'a piece of mangrove wood' (13) shifts to the N2 class, when it is used with a NumP or an AdjP, see Section 8.5.
- N2/N3: Nouns denoting a part of a whole, e.g. *paka* 'leaf', are used as an N2 in the Inalienable Possessive Construction and as a N3 in a simple ART-N construction, see Section 10.

Verbs and Adjectives functioning as NP heads are, with two exceptions, affiliated with the N2 class (Mosel 2017: 274–277, 279). The exceptions are *moroko* 'speak' and *upeupehe* 'think'.

Four N2 words signify distinct kinds of plurality and form compounds with the following Noun referring to the quantified entity:

1. *maa* (PLM), Plural Marker, signifies distributional plurality[23]
2. *maamihu* 'all sorts of', 'every';
3. *ba* (KIN.PLM), the Kinship Plural Marker, denotes a group of people of the same generation sharing the same status in kin relations', e.g. kin relationships such as grandparents, mothers, etc.[24]

[21]For further information see https://dictionaria.clld.org/contributions/teop#section7 and (Mosel 2014a).

[22]Due to the genre of this text collection, the Article of the 1st class is only presented by a total of 14 tokens with singular NPs headed by *beera* 'chief', *guu* 'pig' and *ta* 'piece'.

[23]Distributional plurality means that the NP refers to a plurality of entities that are distributed over space or time and do not form a group, cf. Corbett (2000: 11–117). Compare (53) with (54).

[24]See (1), (37), and https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-ba.

4. *tom* (DYAD), the Dyadic Relationship Marker' means 'group of two or more people who are in a reciprocal kin relationship', e.g. kin relationship such as a mother and her child.[25]

The classification of these four words as N2-Nouns is based on the fact that they are always marked by the singular Article of the 2nd class (ART2.SG) irrespective of the inherent noun class of the following Noun which denotes the quantified entity. This is shown by NPs in which *maa* PLM is followed by an N3 Noun such as *hum* 'place' in (54) and *naono* 'plant', see (57).

(57) *Amaa naono*
a=maa naono
ART2.SG=PLM plant
'the plants' (10:23)

Similar to other Nouns, see Section 5.3, *maa* PLM forms compounds with Verbs, see (58):

(58) *bona maa kiu vahihivaa te suburiori vai a otei.*
bona maa kiu va-hihivaa te
OBL.ART2.SG PLM work ADVR-difficult PREP.ART1.SG
subu-riori vai a otei
grandparent-3PL.POSS.PRON DEM6 ART2.SG man
'the difficult work (lit. works) of their grandfather'
(See https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-vahihivaa_1)

The N2 Noun *maamihu* 'all sorts of, every' is followed by N2-class Nouns, see (59);

(59) *a maamihu taba*
a maamihu taba
ART2.SG all.sorts.of thing
'all the things' (29:4), or 'everything' (33:9)

and by N3-class Nouns, see (60).

(60) *a maamihu hum*
a maamihu hum
ART2.SG all.sorts.of place
'all sorts of places, everywhere' (See
https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-maamihu_hum)

[25]Search (Words extra) in the MTED for the Gloss "DYAD" and find 11 entries.

8.4 Pre-head words that specify the reference of the NP

In addition to the Specific Article, the reference of the NP may be specified by the following six wordforms between the Article and the NP head.

1. The Determiner called Indefiniteness Marker *peha*[2], *peho*[2] (INDEF) 'a, some, any' is a synonym of the Numeral *peha*[1], *peho*[1] 'one'; it is incompatible with the Numeral 'one', but compatible with the Plural Marker *maa*, see Section 8.5.
2. The Determiner *meha*, *meho* 'some item or items (of a group), other' is incompatible with the Indefiniteness Marker and holds the same position.
3. The Numeral *peha*[1], *peho*[1] 'one' is incompatible with the Indefiniteness Marker.
4. The Numeral *bua*, *buo* 'two' is compatible with the Indefiniteness Marker.
5. The Diminutive Particle *sii* (DIM) means 'little' or denotes the speaker's empathy.
6. The Adjective *vahara* 'small (persons or things)' (small.PL).

The sequential order of the pre-head elements is fixed, see Table 17.

Table 17: The pre-head determiners in their sequential order in NPs.

ART	DET	NUM	DIM	ADJ	NOUN	TRANSLATION	REF
A	*peha*	-	-	-	*aba*	'a person, someone'	(26:18)
O		*peho*		-	*sinivi*	'one canoe'	(30:5)
O	*meho*	*buo*		-	*sinivi*	'the other two canoes'	(30:6)
O			*sii*	*vahara*	*vasu*	'the little stones'	(35:6)

The inflecting forms of the Numerals *peha*[1], *peho*[1] 'one', *bua*, *buo* 'two' and the Determiners *peha*[2], *peho*[2] INDEF, *meha*, *meho* 'other' indicate the noun class and grammatical number of the NP. The Numeral *peha*[1], *peho*[1] and the Determiner *meha*/*meho* may function as the head of anaphoric SubstPs, as illustrated by (2) and (6), see Section 4.1.

8.5 The Noun *ta* 'piece' and the Plural Marker *maa*

The Nouns *ta* and *maa* have two properties in common:

1. They head compounds and never occur by themselves.
2. They are repeated in attributive AdjPs.

The Noun *ta* 'piece' belongs to the N1/N2 class[26] and is repeated in a modifying AdjP, see (61).

(61) *A ta naono vai a ta beera, bebeahu ae kikis*
a ta naono vai a ta beera bebeahu ae kikis
ART2.SG piece wood DEM6 ART2.SG piece big long and1 strong
'A big, long and strong pole' (16:3)

Another Noun that is repreated in AdjP is *kara* 'vine', see (11:6), (11:78). The same repetition occurs optionally in NPs headed by *maa* PLM, see (62).

(62) *tea maa nahu vai amaa beera*
te=a maa nahu vai a=maa beera
PREP=ART2.SG PLM pot DEM6 ART2.SG=PLM large
'in large pots' (6:50)

The Plural Marker *maa* and *ta* 'piece' may form a complex compound with a third Noun[27], see (63).

(63) *Amaa ta naono bari mee amaa ta kakato koa.*
a=maa ta naono bari mee a=maa ta kakato koa
ART2.SG=PLM piece wood ANA.PL also ART2.SG=PLM piece short quite
'These poles are quite short.' (16:24)

The repetition of the Plural Marker is also found with the Indefiniteness Marker, see (64)

(64) *Amaa peha maa vuri ...*
a=maa peha maa vuri
ART2.SG=PLM INDEF2.SG PLM time
'Sometimes (they go diving for turtles).' (26:27)

and the Determiner *meha* 'other', see (65).

[26] See: https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-ta_2.

[27] Some authors write *mata* instead of *maa ta*, e.g. *bona mata goroto* 'the pieces of the turtle' (26:47).

(65) *Amaa meha maa ana*
a=maa meha maa ana
ART2.SG=PLM other2.SG PLM root
'Other roots (have also started growing out (of the nut))' (5:17)

9 Pronouns

9.1 The four person categories of Teop Pronouns

The Teop Pronouns distinguish between four persons, singular and plural, and five classes of morpho-syntactic forms: basic Pronouns (PRON), Heavy Pronouns (H-PRON), Object Pronouns (OBJ.PRON), suffixed Possessive Pronouns (POSS-PRON), and the clitic Consecutive Pronoun (PRON=), see Table 18.

The 1st and 2nd Person Pronouns differ morphologically and syntactically from the non-speech-act Pronouns which are called 3rd and 4th Person Pronouns. While the 1st and 2nd Person Object Pronouns are derived from the Basic Pronouns by prefixes, the 3rd Person Pronouns do not distinguish between Basic and Object Pronouns, e.g. *eve*, e 3SG.PRON, *ori* 3PL.PRON. But corresponding to the differential object marking of NPs, see Section 3, the 3rd Person Basic Pronouns only function as an object if the subject Pronoun refers to a speech-act participant, see (66).

Table 18: The Teop Pronouns.

	PRON	H-PRON	OBJ.PRON	POSS-PRON	PRON=
1SG	*naa*	*e-naa*	*a-naa*	*∅-naa*	*ne*[a]
1PL.EX	*nam*	*e-nam*	*a-nam*	*-ma-nam*	-
1PL.IN	*ara*	*e-ara*	*ara-ara*	*-ra-ara*	*a=re*
2SG	*an*	*e-an*	*vu-an*	*-m-an*	-
2PL	*am*	*e-am*	*ame-am*	*-me-am*	-
3SG	*eve, e*	*eove, eve*	*eve, e*	*-na-e*	*o=re*
3PL	*ori*	*e-ori*	*ori*	*-ri-ori*	*o=re*
4SG	-	-	*bona*	-	-
4PL	-	-	*bari*	-	-

[a]See: https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-ne_2. The form occurs in the TLC by itself or follows a subject 1SG.PRON or 2SG.PRON, e.g. *ne nao* 'then I go'. It does not occur in this text-collection.

(66) *Beara tara ahe eve, ...*
be=ara tara ahe eve
when=1PL.IN.PRON see recognize 3SG.PRON
'When we spot it, (we must push the fishing-stick into it.)' (35:7)

If a NP or a 3rd Person Pronoun functions as the subject, the object is formed by the 4th Person Pronoun, see (67).

(67) *... a peha aba na antee nana tea paku bona.*
a peha aba na antee nana tea paku bona
ART2.SG one2.SG person TM2 can 3SG.IPFV COMPL1 do 4SG.PRON
'... a single person can do it.' (24:6)

The plural forms of 3rd and 4th Person Pronouns are used in strikingly different ways. The form *ori* 'they, them' (3PL.PRON) is obligatory when the Pronoun refers to more than one person, see (68).

(68) *ean repaa vaan riori,*
e-an re=paa va-an ri=ori
H=2SG.PRON CONSEC=TM3 CAUS-eat 3PL.OBJM=3PL.PRON
'(When they have pulled the canoe home,) you will give them to eat, ...' (24:37)

With non-human referents the 3rd Person Singular form is selected, see (69).

(69) *Bean kosi vakavara a paka taovu, ean paa kaakaru e bono pesupaava, ...*
be=an kosi va-kavara a paka
when=2SG.PRON cut.off.leaves ADVR-complete ART3.PL leaf
taovu e-an paa kaakaru e bono
giant.pandanus H-2SG.PRON TM3 scrape.thorns.off 3SG.PRON OBJ.ART3.SG
pesupaava
coconut.husk
'After you have cut off the pandanus leaves, you scrape off the thorns with a coconut husk ...' (14:9)

Exceptions are found in contexts where animals function as discourse topics as in the descriptions of marine animals. In other cases as in (21), the writer's usage of the plural form seems to be influenced by English. Consequently, *e, eve* 3SG.PRON is variably translated by English singular or plural pronouns of the 3rd person.

The selection of *bona* 4SG.PRON or *bari* 4PL.PRON does not only depend on the number of their referents, but also on the number of the referent of the subject NP or Pronoun. The Pronoun *bona* 4SG.PRON is only used, when both the subject NP or Pronoun and *bona* 4SG.PRON refer to a single entity as in (67) 'a single person can do it', or *bona* 4SG.PRON refers to inanimate entities.

The plural form *bari* 4PL.PRON refers, as expected, to a plurality of undergoers in clauses with a singular subject NP or Pronoun, see in (70).

(70) *eove repaa mee ri bari rasuu tea aito.*
eove re=paa mee ri bari rasuu tea
H.3SG.PRON CONSEC=TM3 take 3PL.OBJM 4PL.PRON jungle COMPL1
aito
collect.herbs
'(A man who is an expert on herbs selects two or four men,) then he takes them into the jungle to collect herbs.' (28:3)

But unexpectedly, *bari* 4PL.PRON also refers to a single undergoer in clauses with a subject NP or Pronoun referring to a plurality of actors, see (71).

(71) *eori repaa tagava bari*
e-ori re=paa tagava bari
H-3PL.PRON CONSEC=TM3 fell 4PL.PRON
'and then they fell it' (6:45)

The form *bari* 4PL.PRON is not only used in clauses about present habitual events, but also in clauses about individual past events with more than one actor and a single undergoer, see (72).

(72) *meori pae ni bari.*
me=ori pae ni bari
and4=3PL.PRON bury APPL 4PL.PRON
'and they buried him.' (See https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-bari_1)

The reference to a plurality of undergoers in (70) and a single undergoer in (71) and (72) is not distinguished by the object Pronoun, but by the Object Marker *ri* in the VC of (70).

The next four tables present an overview of the syntactic functions of the 1st Person Inclusive Plural Pronouns, the 3rd, the 4th Person Pronouns, and zero anaphora. For reasons of space, the 1st Person Inclusive Plural Pronoun was chosen as presentative for 1st and 2nd Person Pronouns, see Table 19.

Table 19: The functions of 1st Person Inclusive Pronouns.

	SYNTACTIC FUNCTIONS				
FORM GLOSS	CLEFTED PRON.	TOPICAL SUBJ.	TOPICAL OBJ.	NON-TOP. SUBJ.	NON-TOP. OBJ.
e-ara H-1PL.IN.PRON	+[a]	(5:53)	-	-	(81a)
ara 1PL.IN.PRON	-	-	-	(10)	-
a= 1PL.IN.PRON=	-	(78)	-	-	-
araara 1PL.IN.OBJ.PRON	-	-	-	-	(22:20)

[a]There is no example in this text collection, but see *Enaa to vigu bona sikuuru bona.* 'It was me who build this school.' (Rum et al. 2014: 59) and https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-vigu.

The syntactic functions of the 3rd Person Pronouns differ from those of the 1st and 2nd Person Pronouns, see Table 20.

As illustrated by the examples (67), (70), (71) and (72), the distinction of singular and plural 4th Person Pronouns is not exclusively determined by its antecedent, but also by the referent of the subject NP, so that depending on the context both the singular form *bona* and the plural form *bari* are translated by English singular or plural forms, see Table 21.

If an actor or undergoer of a situation is understood from the context, it may not be explicitly mentioned by a NP or Pronoun. This zero-anaphora is found in the topical position of subjects or direct/primary objects and in the position of non-topical direct/primary objects see Table 22.

The following sections describe the functions of the Heavy Pronoun in Section 9.2, and the Consecutive Pronoun in Section 9.3. For the Possessive Pronouns see Section 10.

Table 20: 3rd Person Pronouns and their functions.

	SYNTACTIC FUNCTIONS				
FORM GLOSS	CLEFTED PRON.	TOPICAL SUBJ.	TOPICAL OBJ.	NON-TOP. SUBJ.	NON-TOP. OBJ.
eove H.3SG.PRON	(20:2)	(5:11)	-	-	(refl. obj.)[a]
eve 3SG.PRON	(11:7)	(7:8)	(19:2)	(5:146)	(37:10)[b]
=e 3SG.PRON	-	-	-	(5:165)	(5:141)
o= 3SG/PL.PRON=	-	(5:3)	-	-	-
e-ori H-3PL.PRON	+[c]	(7:11)	-	-	-
ori 3PL.PRON	-	(7:10)	-	(7:10)	(24:37)

[a]When functioning as a reflexive object, it is preceded by the Object Article *bene* (OBJ.ART1.SG), see https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-eove.
[b]See: https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-eve.
[c]*Eori to vigu bona vaan vaa Kekesu.* 'It was them who built the village of Kekesu.' (Morekevan et al. 2014: 46).

Table 21: The 4th person Pronouns and their English translations.

PRONOUN	GLOSS	TRANSLATION	REF
bona	4SG.PRON	it	(5:30), (17:25), (67)
		them	(10:12), (28:4)
bari	4PL.PRON	it, him	(5:116), (7:8), (26:31), (71), (72)
		them	(5:91), (28:3, (70)

Table 22: Zero anaphora.

	SUBJECT	DIRECT/PRIMARY OBJECT
Topical position	(5:7), (10:11)	(5:43), (13:15), (33:2)
Non-topical position	-	(5:154), (5:155), (38:4)

9.2 The Heavy Pronoun

The Heavy Pronoun functions as a clause initial topical subject, see (73),

(73) *eove repaa taneo tea pura hopo vo kasuana.*
eove re=paa taneo tea pura hopo vo kasuana
H.3SG.PRON CONSEC=TM3 start COMPL1 grow enter GOAL ground
'(When the sprouting root comes out,) it starts growing into the ground,' (5:11)

as a clause external focused Pronoun in the so-called "it-cleft construction"[28], see (74),

(74) *Eove to kom, hio ae goroho raara.*
eove to kom hio ae goroho ra=ara
H.3SG.PRON REL step.on sit and1 sleep 1PL.IN.IPFV=1PL.IN.PRON
'(The floor is a thing in our house, the Teop people.) It is where we step, sit, and sleep on.' (20:2)

as the head of a negated VC[29], see (75),

(75) *Saka enaa haana to ato.*
saka e-naa haa=na to ato
NEG1 H-1SG.PRON NEG2=3SG.IPFV REL hold
'(It is) not me who took possession (of it).' (Siarive et al. 2014: 22)

and as a reflexive object Pronoun of a transitive Verb, see (76).

(76) *menaa paa hivi komana enaa,*
me=naa paa hivi komana e-naa
and4=1SG.PRON [TM3 ask self]$_{VC}$ H-1SG.PRON
'and I asked myself,' (See https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-enaa)

[28] Andrews (2007: 133, 149, 152, 155); Lambrecht (1994: 17, 70–71).
[29] Compare (18) in Section 4.2.

The 3rd person reflexive Pronouns are preceded by the Article *bene* OBJ.ART1.SG, see (77).

(77) *mepaa hivi komana bene eve, ...*
me=paa hivi komana bene eve
and4=TM3 red ask self OBJ.ART1.SG 3SG.PRON
'(a young boy found the vine of a yam) and he asked himself, ...' (See https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-bene_eve)

9.3 The Consecutive Pronoun

The Consecutive Clause is a dependent non-embedded clause that is marked by the conjunction *re* 'then, so that' (CONSEC) which holds the position after the obligatory topical subject NP or Pronoun. The VC is marked by the Change-of-Situation Marker *paa* TM3 or unmarked. The subject may be formed by a NP, a Heavy Pronoun (74), or a shortened proclitic form, e.g. *a=re* 'then we' (1PL.IN.PRON=CONSEC), *o=re* 'then he/she/it/they' (3.PRON=CONSEC), which exclusively occur in this clause type, see (78).

(78) *are paa varoava e, ore raka.*
a=re paa va-roava e o=re
1PL.IN.PRON=CONSEC TM3 CAUS-be.in.the.sun 3SG.PRON 3.PRON=CONSEC
raka
dry
'(After having scraped the wild banana plant,) we put it in the sun so that it becomes dry.' (11:56)

The construction *ore suguna* 'until' (lit. 'then it reaches') is a common way of expressing that some situation comes to an end, see (5:164), (34:21), (37:16).[30]

10 Alienable and Inalienable Possessive Constructions

The Alienable Possessive Construction (Al.Poss.Constr) is formed by a NP that is headed by a Noun or a Verb and followed by a PrepP introduced by *te* PREP. This PrepP refers to the owner of the referent of the NP, e.g. *a inu te=ara* 'our house' (22), its consumer, e.g. *a tabaan te=o burumakao* 'the food of the cows' (24), and the actor, e.g. *a kiu vahihiva te suburiori* 'the difficult work of their grandparent' (58).

[30] See: https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-suguna.

The Inalienable Possessive Construction (Inal.Poss.Constr.) is formed by a NP that with one exception is marked by the Possessive Marker, see Table 18, and is obligatorily followed by another NP, see (79),

(79) *o paka no overe*
o paka n=o overe
ART2.PL leaf 3SG.POSS=ART3.SG coconut.palm
'the leaves of the coconut palm' (5:15)

or a Pronoun, see (80).

(80) *A ba suburaara ...*
a ba subu-ra-ara
[ART2.SG KIN.PLM grandparent-1PL.IN.POSS-1PL.IN.PRON]$_{NP}$
'our grandparents ...' (5:75)

The standard orthography of *o paka no overe* 'the leaves of the coconut palm' in (79) does not reflect its morphosyntactic structure, because the Possessive Marker *n* 3SG.POSS is suffixed to *paka* 'leaf' and signifies its relationality, whereas the Article *o* introduces the complement NP *o overe*. The Possessive Marker inflects for person and number and indexes the complement NP or Pronoun with the exception of the 1st Person Singular Pronoun *naa*, see Table 18 in Section 9.1.

In (80) the segmentation of *subu-ra-ara* 'our grandparent' and its glossing render the morphological structure of the word, but in other examples and in the texts, the sequence of a Possessive Marker and a Basic Pronoun is treated as a single linguistic unit, e.g. *a ba subu-raara* 'our grandparents (ART2.SG grandparent-1PL.IN.POSS.PRON' (1), (37).

The Inal.Poss.Constr. denotes the following relationships:[31]

- unalterable kinship, see (80);
- a body part and the human or animal it belongs to (33);
- a part of a whole (25);
- the name of a person, animal, or thing (51);
- the size of a thing (5:54), (16:42), (19:28);
- the quantity of things (16:29);

[31]Search (Words extra) in the MTED for the Gloss "POSS" and find 137 entries.

- a spatial relationship (23); (5:33); (5:161), (32:8);
- a temporal relationship (22:15), (22:19),
- an action and its undergoer (28);
- the relation between a property and the bearer of the property (81);
- a comparative relationship.[32]

The head of the following Inal.Poss.Constr. *mataa* 'good' is classified as an Adjective, because the selection of the Article *a* (ART2.SG) is determined by the preceding context, i.e. the surrendering which is *a hata* 'bad', see (81).

(81) a. *Beara hee komana ni eara, a hata,*
be=ara hee komana ni e-ara a hata
when=1PL.IN.PRON give self APPL H-1PL.IN.PRON ART2.SG bad
'If we surrender (lit. give ourselves), it is bad,'

b. *evehee na tei me nana bona mataa nae mee.*
evehee na tei me nana bona mataa nae
but TM2 be.there with 3SG.IPFV OBJ.ART2.SG good 3SG.POSS.PRON
mee
also
'but it also has its good side.' (Mahaka et al. 2014: 105)

Relational Nouns can be derelationalized by the suffix *-na* 'DEREL',[33] as, for example *toon-* 'top', see (82),

(82) *bono kapa vaa toonuna,*
bono kapa vaa toonu-na
OBJ.ART3.SG cover LNK top-DEREL
'(they start scraping off) the top cover (lit. the cover of the top),' (8:15)

or the kinship term *sina-* 'mother', see (83).

(83) *to sinivi kiri bona vuu tom sinana.*
to sinivi ki=ri bona vuu tom sina=na
NSPEC3.SG canoe DAT=3PL.OBJM ART2.SG cluster DYAD mother=DEREL
'a canoe for the family.' (7:15)[34]

[32] See Mosel (2017: 279–280), https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-babarii, and https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-kirisi_1.
[33] Search (Words extra) in the MTED for the Gloss "DEREL" and find 63 examples.
[34] Search (Words extra) in the MTED for the Gloss "DYAD" and find 11 examples.

Other nouns, e.g. *paka* 'leaf' are marked by the ART2 Article, when they head a Inal.Poss.Constr. as in (79), but by the ART3 Article (69), when they are used as a non-relational Noun.[35]

11 Dependent Clauses

11.1 Introduction

There are two kinds of dependent clauses in Teop that are marked by a conjunction:

1. Subordinate Clauses that hold the position of a clause constituent,
2. Dependent Non-Embedded Clauses.

Thirdly, there are unmarked dependent clauses in which a syntactically obligatory subject or object NP or Pronoun is missing, but understood from the context. For examples see Table 22 in Section 9.1.

11.2 Subordinate Clauses

Subordinate clauses are found with 7 syntactic functions, see Table 23.
Comments:

- The Relative Clause is introduced by the Relative Pronoun *to* REL, unless the following VC starts with the TM-Marker *tau* 'about to' (TM5) or *toro* 'must' (TM7). The Relative Pronoun does not inflect and functions as a subject, object, oblique object or adjunct of the Relative clause. The Relative Clause functions as an attribute, and similar to NPs and PrepPs, as a predicate, subject, object, oblique object, and a locative or temporal Adjunct.
- Complement clauses introduced by *tea* (COMPL1) are similar to English to-infinitive clauses. Either the subject or the object NP or Pronoun of the matrix clause functions as their subject. Those introduced by *be*^{2} (COMPL2) have a subject NP that is different from the subject of the main clause.
- The Purposive Clause is introduced by *mene* 'for' and structurally similar to the *tea*-Complement Clause, but differs with respect to its syntactic functions and meaning, see Table 23.

[35] Search the MTED for the Part of Speech "N2/N3" and find 53 entries.; also see Mosel (2014a: 59–64).

Table 23: Subordinate clauses.

FUNCTIONS	SUBORDINATE CLAUSES				
	RELATIVE	*be*[1]- ADVERBIAL	*be*[2]- COMPL.	*tea*- COMPL.	*mene*- PURPOSIVE
predicate	(5:56)	-	(5:176)	(31:8)	(30:6)
subject	(33:11)	-	-	(5:146)	-
object	-	-	(5:12)	(5:11)	-
oblique object	(17:40)	-	(5:164)	(5:177)	-
attribute	(5:57)	-	-	-	(12:7)
compl. of LNK	-	-	-	(5:180)	-
adjunct	(17:30)	(5:2)	-	-	(29:31)

- The Adverbial Clause is introduced by *be*[1] 'when, if'. In the texts about the growth of plants and the production of artefacts temporal Adverbial Clauses typically precede a matrix clause that is frequently marked by the consecutive conjunction *re* 'then' (CONSEC).

11.3 Dependent Non-Embedded Clauses

The three types of dependent non-embedded clauses are linked to a preceding clause by a conjunction:

1. the Consecutive Clause (436 tokens) is marked by *re* 'then, so that' (CONSEC) after a topical NP or Pronoun with, see Section 9.3 and https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-re.
2. the Adversative Clause (35 tokens) is marked by *he* 'but, while' (ADVERS) is the same position as the conjunction re in the Consecutive Clause, see https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-he.
3. the Coordinative Clause (19 tokens) is introduced by the conjunction *me* 'and' (and4), see https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-me_1.

12 Filtered Searches in the Multifunctional Teop-English Dictionary (MTED)

The MTED has two interfaces for filtered searches. The first is called "Words"[36], the second is called "Words extra"[37], see Figures 1 and 2. The column label "MWE Structure" stands for "Multi-Word-Expression Structure". Example searches are shown in Tables 24 and 25.

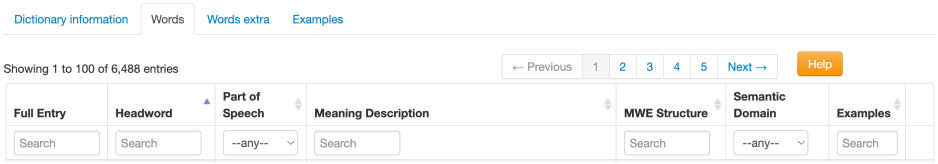


Figure 1: Search interface "Words".

Table 24: Examples for searches in two fields in "Words"

TOPIC	SEARCH QUERY		HITS
	FIELD: "KEYWORD"	FIELD: "KEYWORD"	
Temporal adverbs	Part of Speech: "adv"	Semantic Domain: "time"	35
Intransitive VCs with a transitive verb	Part of Speech: "vi.constr"	MWE Structure: "vt"	72
Transitive VCs with an incorporated preposition	Part of Speech: "vt.constr"	MWE Structure: "Prep"	166

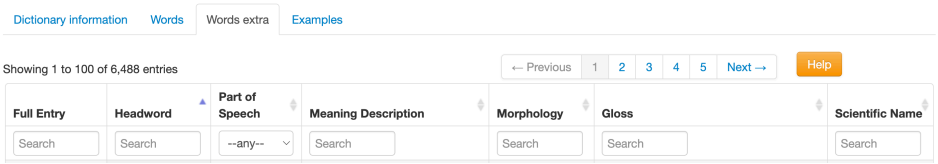


Figure 2: Search interface "Words extra".

[36] See: https://dictionaria.clld.org/contributions/teop#twords.
[37] See: https://dictionaria.clld.org/contributions/teop#twords2.

Table 25: Examples for searches in two fields in "Words extra".

TOPIC	SEARCH QUERY		HITS
	FIELD: "KEYWORD"	FIELD: "KEYWORD"	
Possessive Constructions	Part of Speech: "n1.constr"	Gloss: "poss"	21
	Part of Speech: "n2.constr"	Gloss: "poss"	86
	Part of Speech: "n3.constr"	Gloss: "poss"	7
Intransitive Verbs with a causative prefix	Part of Speech: "vi"	Gloss: "^CAUS"	17
Transitive Verbs with a causative prefix	Part of Speech: "vt"	Gloss: "^CAUS"	192
NPs headed by a causative verb	Part of Speech: "n2.constr"	Gloss: "^CAUS"	2